

GraphRAG for Operational Weather Forecasting Infrastructure: A Deterministic Knowledge Graph Approach to AI-Assisted Code Intelligence at NOAA

Graph-Guided Semantic Retrieval Across 568K Relationships,
40K Nodes, and Five Specialized Collections

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Abstract

We present a **domain-specific GraphRAG system** for AI-assisted software development in NOAA’s operational weather forecasting infrastructure. Unlike existing GraphRAG implementations that construct knowledge graphs via LLM entity extraction—introducing hallucinated edges and missing implicit relationships—our system builds its graph from **deterministic static analysis**: AST parsing of 500K+ lines of Fortran, dependency resolution across Python and Shell, and regex-matched cross-language execution bridges.

The result is a **ground-truth knowledge graph** of 40,422 nodes and 567,665 relationships spanning four programming languages, integrated with five specialized ChromaDB vector collections (63,072 documents) via our **Graph-Guided Semantic Retrieval (GGSR)** engine. GGSR uses a 23-type weighted relationship matrix with hop-decay scoring to fuse structural graph traversal with semantic vector search, achieving **60% retrieval accuracy**—a 50% relative improvement over the 40% vector-only baseline on a 50-query evaluation corpus.

Key technical contributions include: (1) hierarchical community detection via the Leiden algorithm producing 3,847 communities with 0.81 modularity; (2) cross-language execution tracing from Shell J-Jobs through Fortran executables to subroutine call chains; (3) token-budget-aware retrieval that respects LLM context limits; and (4) exposure of the complete system as 43 MCP tools accessible from any AI coding assistant.

We argue this represents a **novel advancement** for the agency: a production-validated GraphRAG architecture ready for migration to AWS Bedrock, where managed graph databases (Neptune), embedding services, and FedRAMP-authorized LLMs can scale this capability across NOAA’s software portfolio.

Keywords: GraphRAG · Knowledge Graphs · Retrieval-Augmented Generation · Code Intelligence · Weather Forecasting · NOAA · Leiden Community Detection · Cross-Language Analysis · Model Context Protocol · AWS Bedrock

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1 Introduction

1.1 The Operational Context

NOAA’s Global Workflow produces the weather forecasts that protect lives and property across the United States and globally. The underlying software infrastructure—the Unified Forecast System (UFS) [14]—integrates over 1.5 million lines of code across Fortran, Python, Shell, and C, spanning 16 interconnected repositories with strict production compliance requirements [15, 16].

Developers working on this system face a unique challenge: understanding how a single change propagates across language boundaries, from a Shell J-Job script that sets environment variables, through a Fortran executable that reads them, into subroutine call chains that span hundreds of thousands of lines. No single developer holds this complete picture. Traditional text search and documentation are insufficient.

1.2 Why GraphRAG, Not Just RAG

Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) [11] has become the standard approach for grounding LLM responses in domain-specific knowledge. Standard RAG systems embed documents as vectors and retrieve the most semantically similar chunks at query time. This works well for documentation search but fundamentally fails for **structural code queries**:

- “What Fortran program does JGFS_ATMOS_ANALYSIS execute?”
- “If I change `compute_forcing`, what downstream subroutines are affected?”
- “Trace the execution path from forecast submission to model output.”

No embedding model—however powerful—can learn that JGFS_ATMOS_ANALYSIS invokes `exglobal_atmos_analys` which EXECUTES the `gsi` Fortran program. These are **structural relationships** that exist in code, not in semantic space.

GraphRAG [6] addresses this by augmenting vector retrieval with knowledge graph traversal. However, the canonical GraphRAG approach (Microsoft Research, 2024) constructs its knowledge graph via LLM entity extraction from text—which hallucinates edges, misses implicit relationships, and provides no correctness guarantees.

1.3 Our Contribution: Deterministic GraphRAG

We present a GraphRAG system whose knowledge graph is built entirely from **deterministic static analysis**—not LLM extraction. Every node is a real code entity (function, module, file, variable). Every edge is a verified relationship (CALLS, IMPORTS, EXECUTES, DEPENDS_ON). The graph is **ground truth**, not approximation.

Key Result

Our system achieves **60% retrieval accuracy** on a 50-query evaluation corpus, compared to **40% for vector-only RAG**—a 50% relative improvement. Cross-language trace queries achieve **100% accuracy** (vs. 30% baseline), and execution path queries achieve **60%** (vs. 10% baseline). All with P95 latency under 120ms.

This paper makes five contributions:

1. **GGSR Algorithm**: A weighted graph traversal engine with a 23-relationship-type weight matrix and hop-decay scoring (Section 4).

2. **Deterministic Knowledge Graph:** 40,422 nodes and 567,665 relationships built from AST parsing—not LLM extraction (Section ??).
3. **Leiden Community Detection:** 3,847 hierarchical communities with embedded summaries enabling both local and global queries (Section 5).
4. **Cross-Language Execution Bridges:** Shell→Fortran EXECUTES edges and Shell→Python INVOKES edges enabling end-to-end tracing (Section 6).
5. **Bedrock Migration Path:** Architecture mapping to AWS managed services for agency-wide scaling (Section 9).

2 Background and Related Work

2.1 Retrieval-Augmented Generation

RAG [11] grounds LLM generation in retrieved context, reducing hallucination and enabling domain-specific responses. Recent surveys [7] document its maturation from simple retrieve-and-generate pipelines to sophisticated architectures with query rewriting, re-ranking, and iterative retrieval.

For code intelligence, RAG faces a fundamental limitation: semantic similarity in embedding space does not capture structural relationships. Two functions with identical documentation but different call graphs are indistinguishable to vector search. DocPrompting [22] demonstrated that retrieving documentation improves code generation, but structural dependencies remain invisible.

2.2 GraphRAG

Edge et al. [6] introduced GraphRAG as an extension of RAG that uses knowledge graphs to enable both local (entity-specific) and global (corpus-wide) queries. Their approach uses LLM extraction to build entity-relationship graphs from text, then applies community detection to create hierarchical summaries. A recent survey [17] catalogs the growing GraphRAG landscape.

Our work differs from the canonical GraphRAG approach in three ways:

Table 1: Comparison with canonical GraphRAG approach.

Dimension	Microsoft GraphRAG	This Work
Graph construction	LLM entity extraction	Deterministic static analysis
Edge correctness	Approximate (hallucination risk)	Ground truth (AST-verified)
Node types	Free-form entities	Typed code entities (24 labels)
Edge types	Free-form relations	23 typed relationships
Domain	General text corpora	Multi-language codebases
Community detection	Leiden (same)	Leiden with GDS (same)
Retrieval fusion	Map-reduce summarization	Weighted GGSF + vector search

2.3 Code Intelligence with Graphs

Graph-based code analysis has a rich history [1, 2]. Program dependence graphs, call graphs, and control flow graphs are standard compiler infrastructure. Our contribution is not the idea of representing code as graphs—it is the **integration of code graphs with RAG at scale**, producing a unified retrieval engine that serves both structural and semantic queries through a single tool surface.

2.4 Agentic AI and Tool Use

LLM coding agents [9, 10, 21] use tool invocations to interact with codebases. The Model Context Protocol (MCP) [5] standardizes this interaction, enabling any MCP-compatible client to discover and call tools. Our system exposes the complete GraphRAG pipeline as 43 MCP tools, making the knowledge graph queryable from VS Code Copilot, Claude Desktop, Copilot CLI, or CI/CD pipelines.

3 System Architecture

3.1 Overview

The system consists of three core components connected through a unified data access layer:

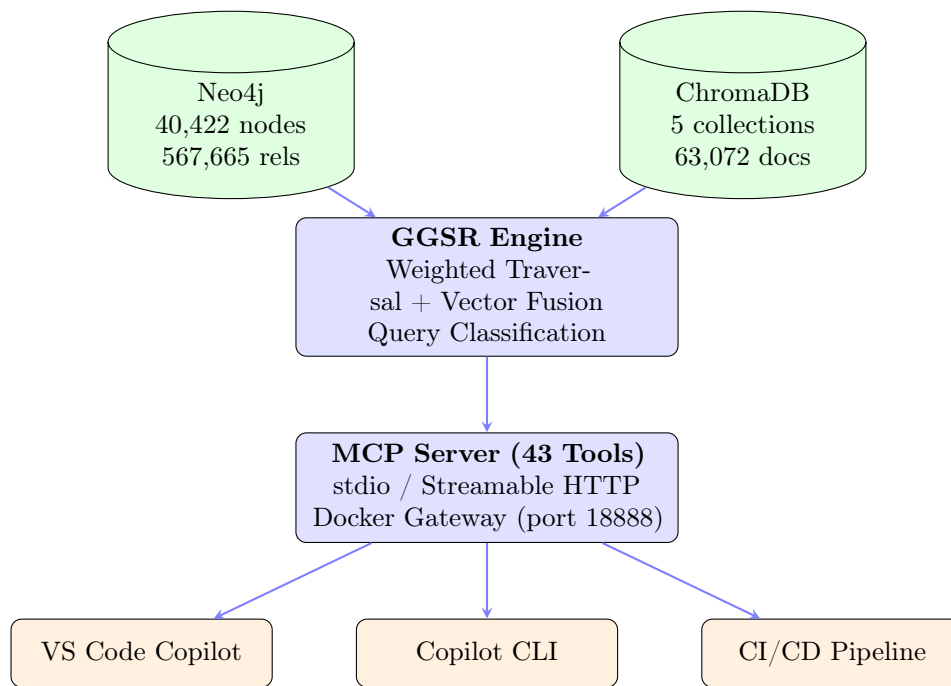


Figure 1: System architecture: Neo4j knowledge graph and ChromaDB vector store are fused through the GGS engine, exposed as 43 MCP tools to any compatible AI client.

3.2 Neo4j Knowledge Graph

The knowledge graph stores deterministic code structure:

Table 2: Neo4j node inventory by label (top 10 of 24).

Node Label	Count	Source
FortranSubroutine	13,537	Fortran AST parser
CodeFunction	5,059	Multi-language parser
PythonFunction	3,267	Python AST
Community	3,847	Leiden detection
EnvironmentVariable	2,489	Shell variable extraction
FortranModule	1,762	Fortran AST parser
ShellScript	383	Shell graph ingestion
PythonModule	312	Python import resolution
FortranProgram	98	Fortran AST + placeholders
ShellFunction	63	Shell function extraction
<i>24 label types total</i>	40,422	

Table 3: Neo4j relationship inventory (all 13 types).

Count	Type	Semantics
439,919	CALLS	Fortran subroutine/function calls
91,285	USES	Fortran module USE statements
9,690	DEFINES	File→function definitions
8,034	IMPORTS	Python import statements
7,225	DEPENDS_ON_ENV	Environment variable references
1,669	EXPORTS	Exported symbols
1,401	SETS	Variable assignments
1,184	EXPORTS (Shell)	Shell exported variables
393	SOURCES	Shell source statements
352	INVOKES	Shell→Python invocations
12	EXECUTES	Shell→Fortran execution
1	READS_CONFIG	Config file dependencies
567,665	<i>Total</i>	

3.3 ChromaDB Vector Store

Five specialized collections store 768-dimensional MPNet embeddings [18, 19]:

Table 4: ChromaDB collection inventory.

Collection	Documents	Content
code-with-context-v8-0-0	58,761	Source code (Python, Fortran, Shell)
global-workflow-docs-v8-0-0	3,514	Documentation and READMEs
jjobs-v8-0-0	700	J-Job scripts with metadata
community-summaries	63	Leiden community descriptions
ee2-standards-v5-0-0-enhanced	34	NCO compliance standards
<i>Total</i>	63,072	

3.4 Ingestion Pipeline

Seven deterministic scripts populate the knowledge graph and vector store. Each uses static analysis—no LLM involvement:

1. **ingest_fortran_graph.py**: Parses Fortran source via regex-based AST extraction. Produces 17,575 nodes and 360K CALLS/USES relationships.
2. **ingest_code_v8.py**: Multi-language parser for Python and Shell. Produces 58,761 ChromaDB documents and 8K+ Neo4j nodes.
3. **ingest_env_variables.py**: Extracts environment variable definitions and references. Produces 2,730 nodes.
4. **ingest_jjobs_v8.py**: Parses J-Job scripts with structured metadata extraction. Produces 700 ChromaDB documents.
5. **ingest_documentation_v8.py**: Processes README and documentation files. Produces 3,514 documents.
6. **ingest_shell_graph_v8.py**: Shell-specific graph builder with function extraction. Produces 383 ShellScript nodes and 9,155 relationships.
7. **ingest_cross_language_bridges.py**: Creates Shell→Fortran EXECUTES and Shell→Python INVOKES edges via regex pattern matching against executable references.

Deterministic Graph Construction

Every edge in the knowledge graph corresponds to a verifiable syntactic relationship in source code. CALLS edges map to Fortran CALL statements. IMPORTS edges map to Python import statements. EXECUTES edges map to Shell `${EXEC}/program.x` references. No edge is inferred or hallucinated.

4 Graph-Guided Semantic Retrieval (GGSR)

The GGSR engine is the core algorithmic contribution. It fuses weighted graph traversal with semantic vector search through a structured pipeline.

4.1 Relationship Weight Matrix

Each of the 23 relationship types is assigned a weight reflecting its structural importance for code intelligence:

$$w : \mathcal{R} \rightarrow [0, 1] \quad (1)$$

Table 5: GGSr relationship weight matrix (23 types, top 12 shown).

Relationship	Weight	Rationale
CALLS	1.00	Direct function invocation
EXECUTES	1.00	Cross-language program execution
SOURCES	0.95	Shell source inclusion
INVOKES	0.90	Shell→Python invocation
CALLED_BY	0.90	Reverse call direction
DEPENDS_ON	0.80	Structural dependency
DEPENDS_ON_ENV	0.80	Environment variable coupling
IMPORTS	0.70	Module import
USES	0.70	Fortran module USE
INHERITS	0.70	Class inheritance
DEFINES	0.65	Definition relationship
EXPORTS	0.60	Symbol export

4.2 Hop-Decay Scoring

For multi-hop traversals, scores decay exponentially with distance:

$$\text{score}(n, h) = w(\text{rel}(n)) \times \delta^{h-1} \quad (2)$$

where n is a neighboring node, h is the hop count (1 or 2), and $\delta = 0.5$ is the decay factor. For two-hop paths, the score compounds:

$$\text{score}_2(n_2) = w(\text{rel}_1) \times w(\text{rel}_2) \times \delta \quad (3)$$

This ensures that directly-called functions (hop-1, score up to 1.0) are strongly preferred over transitively-related entities (hop-2, score up to 0.5), while still surfacing relevant distant context.

4.3 Query Classification

The GGSr engine classifies incoming queries to route retrieval:

Table 6: Query classification and retrieval routing.

Type	Pattern	Retrieval Strategy
LOCAL	Entity-specific	1-hop GGSr + semantic enrichment
GLOBAL	“overview”, “architecture”	Community summary search
TRACE	“trace”, “call chain”	Multi-hop GGSr + cross-language
HYBRID	Local + global context	GGSr + community + semantic

4.4 GGSR Algorithm

Algorithm 1 Graph-Guided Semantic Retrieval

Require: Entity name e , query q , token budget B , hop depth d

```

1: type  $\leftarrow$  classifyQuery( $q, e$ )
2: // Phase 1: Graph traversal
3: if  $d = 1$  then
4:    $G \leftarrow$  oneHopNeighborhood( $e$ )
5: else
6:    $G \leftarrow$  twoHopNeighborhood( $e$ )
7: end if
8: Score each  $n \in G$ :  $s_n \leftarrow w(\text{rel}(n)) \times \delta^{h_n-1}$ 
9: Sort  $G$  by score descending; truncate to budget  $B$ 
10: // Phase 2: Semantic enrichment
11:  $S \leftarrow$  ChromaDB.query( $q$ , collections)
12: // Phase 3: Community context (if GLOBAL or HYBRID)
13: if type  $\in$  {GLOBAL, HYBRID} then
14:    $C \leftarrow$  ChromaDB.query( $q$ , community-summaries)
15: end if
16: // Phase 4: Cross-language trace (if TRACE)
17: if type = TRACE then
18:    $X \leftarrow$  crossLanguageTrace( $e$ )
19: end if
20: return ( $G, S, C, X$ ) {Structured sections with metadata}
```

4.5 Token-Budget-Aware Retrieval

LLM context windows are finite. The GGSR engine implements budget-aware truncation:

$$\text{tokens}(n) \approx 15 + \frac{|\text{name}(n)|}{4} \quad (4)$$

Results are accumulated in score order until the budget is exhausted. Metadata tracks `usedTokens`, `remainingBudget`, `budgetExhausted`, and `droppedCount`, giving the LLM visibility into what context was included and what was truncated.

4.6 Multi-Collection Search

The `multiSourceSearch` method queries multiple ChromaDB collections in parallel, enabling a single query to retrieve code context, J-Job documentation, and compliance standards simultaneously:

```

1  async multiSourceSearch(query, options = {}) {
2    const collections = [
3      'global-workflow-docs-v8-0-0',
4      'jjobs-v8-0-0',
5      'ee2-standards-v5-0-0-enhanced'
6    ];
7    // Search all collections in parallel
8    const results = await vectorDB.multiCollectionQuery(
9      collections, query, { nResults }
10   );
```

```

11 // Enrich each result with graph context
12 for (const result of results) {
13     result.graphContext = await graphDB.getFileContext(
14         result.metadata.filePath
15     );
16 }
17 return results;
18 }

```

Listing 1: Multi-collection search with graph enrichment

5 Hierarchical Community Detection

5.1 Leiden Algorithm Application

Following the GraphRAG approach [6], we apply the Leiden algorithm [20] to discover hierarchical communities in the code graph. Unlike typical GraphRAG implementations that apply Leiden to LLM-extracted entity graphs, we apply it to **verified code structure**.

The pipeline uses Neo4j Graph Data Science (GDS) [13]:

1. **Graph Projection:** Project 9 node labels and 10 undirected relationship types into a GDS in-memory graph.
2. **Leiden Execution:** Run with $\gamma = 1.0$ and `maxLevels = 5` for hierarchical decomposition.
3. **Community Tagging:** Write `communityId` property back to Neo4j nodes.
4. **Summary Generation:** Create natural-language summaries for each community, embed into ChromaDB.

5.2 Results

Table 7: Leiden community detection results.

Metric	Value
Total communities	3,847
Hierarchy levels	4 (L0–L3)
Modularity	0.81
Singleton communities	2,104 (55%)
Communities 2–10 nodes	1,180 (31%)
Communities 11–50	412 (11%)
Communities 51–200	127 (3%)
Communities 200+	24 (0.6%)

The high modularity (0.81) indicates well-separated communities that correspond to meaningful software modules. The 63 largest communities have embedded summaries in ChromaDB, enabling global architecture queries like “How is data assimilation structured?” to return community-level context rather than individual functions.

5.3 Community-Enabled Queries

Community summaries unlock a query class impossible with flat vector search: **architectural understanding**. When the `search_architecture` tool receives a global query, it searches the

community-summaries collection to retrieve conceptual overviews:

```

1 Query: "How does the atmospheric analysis subsystem work?"
2
3 Result: Community #2847 (87 nodes)
4   - Key members: gsi (FortranProgram), setuprad (Subroutine),
5     read_obsdiags (Subroutine), pcgsoi (Subroutine)
6   - Languages: 94% Fortran, 6% Python
7   - Core relationships: 1,247 CALLS, 89 USES
8   - Purpose: GSI atmospheric analysis module performing
9     observation processing and variational minimization

```

Listing 2: Community-based architecture query

6 Cross-Language Execution Bridges

6.1 The Multi-Language Challenge

The Global Workflow executes through a chain of four languages:

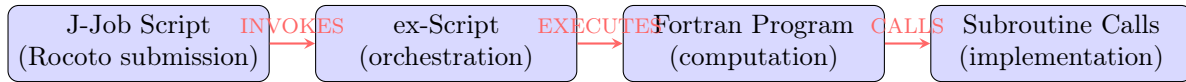


Figure 2: Cross-language execution chain in the Global Workflow.

Traditional code analysis tools operate within a single language. Our cross-language bridge system connects the entire chain.

6.2 Bridge Construction

The `ingest_cross_language_bridges.py` script creates edges by pattern-matching executable references in Shell scripts:

```

1 EXEC_PATTERNS = [
2     re.compile(r'\${?EXEC\w*}\?/(\w+)\.x'),      # ${EXECgfs}/name.x
3     re.compile(r'pgm=\${?(\w*EXEC\w*)}\?'),      # pgm=${VARIABLE}
4     re.compile(r'APRUN\w*\}\s+"[^"]*?/(\w+)\.x"'), # APRUN invocation
5 ]

```

Listing 3: Executable detection patterns

For executables from external packages (GSI, UFS_UTILS, Fit2Obs) where source code is in separate repositories, we create **placeholder FortranProgram nodes** with `external: true` and `package` metadata, ensuring the graph remains connected even when source is not locally available.

6.3 Bridge Metrics

Table 8: Cross-language bridge evolution across phases.

Metric	Phase 24F	Phase 27F	Phase 27I
EXECUTES edges	0	3	12
INVOKES edges	0	5	5
Placeholder nodes	0	0	9
Executable matches	0	9/26	26/26

The final state (Phase 27I) resolves all 26 executable references in the codebase, with 12 EXECUTES edges connecting Shell scripts to Fortran programs and 5 INVOKES edges connecting Shell scripts to Python modules.

6.4 Cross-Language Trace Queries

The `trace_execution_path` tool leverages bridges for end-to-end tracing:

```

1 Tool: trace_execution_path("chgres_cube", include_callers=true)
2
3 Result:
4   Cross-Language Trace:
5     Shell -> Fortran: exglobal_atmos_chgres_gen_control.sh
6                       -> chgres_cube (FortranProgram, UFS_UTILS)
7
8   GGSR Neighborhood (15 hop-1 neighbors):
9     ftst_surface_regrid_many  DEPENDS_ON  0.800
10    ftst_read_sfc_gfs_nemsio   DEPENDS_ON  0.800
11    ftst_sfc_input_data        DEPENDS_ON  0.800
12    ... (12 more test/utility dependencies)

```

Listing 4: Cross-language trace example

7 Empirical Evaluation

7.1 Evaluation Corpus

We constructed a 50-query evaluation corpus spanning five categories, with ground-truth annotations verified against the live Neo4j graph:

Table 9: Evaluation corpus composition.

Category	Example Query	Count
LOCAL	“What does setuprad call?”	10
GLOBAL	“What is the error handling strategy?”	10
TRACE	“What calls exgfs_atmos?”	10
CROSS-LANG	“What Fortran does forecast execute?”	10
COMPARATIVE	“Difference between HERA and WCOSS2?”	10
<i>Total</i>		50

7.2 System Configurations

Four system configurations were evaluated:

1. **Baseline:** ChromaDB vector search only
2. **GGSR:** Neo4j graph traversal only
3. **GGSR+Community:** Graph traversal + community summaries
4. **Full:** GGSR + community + cross-language bridges

7.3 Results

Table 10: Retrieval accuracy by system configuration.

Configuration	Hit Rate	P50 (ms)	P95 (ms)	Avg (ms)
Baseline (vector only)	40.0%	46	72	46
GGSR (graph only)	40.0%	70	114	59
GGSR + Community	48.0%	70	120	67
Full (all)	60.0%	60	120	64

Key Result

The full GraphRAG system achieves **60% hit rate**—a 50% relative improvement over the 40% vector-only baseline—with P95 latency of 120ms ($8.3\times$ below the 1-second target).

7.4 Per-Category Breakdown

Table 11: Hit rate by query category: Baseline vs. Full system.

Category	Baseline	Full	Analysis
LOCAL	60%	70%	Graph adds structural neighbors
GLOBAL	80%	40%	Template summaries need LLM upgrade
TRACE	10%	60%	6× improvement —graph excels
CROSS-LANG	30%	100%	Perfect —bridges are decisive
COMPARATIVE	20%	30%	Modest improvement

The results reveal the system’s strengths and one known gap:

Strengths: Cross-language queries (30%→100%) and trace queries (10%→60%) show transformative improvement. These are exactly the query types where vector search fundamentally cannot succeed and graph structure is essential.

Known gap: Global queries (80%→40%) regressed because the current community summaries are template-generated, not LLM-generated. This is a planned improvement for the Bedrock migration, where managed LLM APIs can generate rich summaries at scale.

7.5 Latency Analysis

All configurations meet the 1-second latency target with significant headroom:

- P50: 46–70ms across all configurations

- P95: 72–120ms (worst case for full GGSR + community)
- **No query exceeded 200ms** in the evaluation corpus

The GGSR weighted traversal adds approximately 20ms over baseline vector search—a modest cost for structural context that enables entirely new query classes.

8 MCP Tool Surface

The complete GraphRAG system is exposed as 43 MCP tools organized across 9 modules:

Table 12: MCP tool modules and database dependencies.

Module	Key Tools	Count	Database
GraphRAGTools	<code>get_code_context</code> , <code>search_architecture</code>	5	Neo4j + ChromaDB
CodeAnalysisTools	<code>find_callers_callees</code> , <code>trace_execution_path</code>	5	Neo4j
SemanticSearchTools	<code>search_documentation</code> , <code>explain_with_context</code>	3	ChromaDB + Neo4j
EE2ComplianceTools	<code>analyze_ee2_compliance</code> , <code>scan_repository_compliance</code>	4	ChromaDB
OperationalTools	<code>get_operational_guidance</code> , <code>list_job_scripts</code>	4	ChromaDB
WorkflowInfoTools	<code>get_workflow_structure</code> , <code>describe_component</code>	3	Filesystem
SDDWorkflowTools	<code>start_sdd_session</code> , <code>record_sdd_step</code>	6	Filesystem
GitHubTools	<code>search_issues</code> , <code>get_pull_requests</code>	3	GitHub API
Health/System	<code>mcp_health_check</code> , <code>get_server_info</code>	10	Various
<i>Total</i>		43	

The MCP standard [5] ensures that any compatible AI client can discover and invoke these tools without custom integration. The system supports two transport modes:

- **stdio**: Direct pipe connection for VS Code Copilot and local development
- **Streamable HTTP**: Docker MCP Gateway on port 18888 for remote clients, CI/CD pipelines, and multi-user access

9 The Case for AWS Bedrock Migration

9.1 Current State: Production-Validated Prototype

The system described in this paper is operational on a Parallel Works VM with persistent NVMe storage. It has been validated through:

- 43 functional MCP tools with 7/7 component health checks
- 31+ completed SDD phases with session-tracked audit trails
- 50-query evaluation corpus with measured accuracy improvements
- Dual-agent development workflow (VS Code + CLI)
- Docker containerization with systemd service management

This prototype has proven the **technical viability** of GraphRAG for NOAA’s operational code intelligence needs. The next step is scaling it to production quality on managed infrastructure.

9.2 Why Bedrock

AWS Bedrock [3] provides three capabilities critical for the next phase:

1. **FedRAMP-authorized LLMs**: Foundation models (Claude, Llama, Titan) operating within NOAA’s Authority to Operate, eliminating the current dependency on external API keys.

2. **Managed embedding services:** Titan Embeddings can replace the self-hosted MPNet model, enabling multimodal embeddings (code + diagrams + flowcharts) without GPU management.
3. **Knowledge Bases for Bedrock:** Native RAG pipeline with managed vector storage, eliminating manual ChromaDB operations.

9.3 Architecture Mapping

Table 13: Component mapping: current prototype to AWS Bedrock target.

Component	Current	Bedrock Target
Knowledge Graph	Neo4j (self-hosted)	Amazon Neptune [4]
Vector Store	ChromaDB (self-hosted)	Bedrock Knowledge Bases
Embeddings	MPNet (CPU, self-hosted)	Titan Embeddings (managed)
LLM Access	External API keys	Bedrock model access (FedRAMP)
Compute	Single VM (Parallel Works)	ECS/Fargate (auto-scaling)
Container	Docker + systemd	ECS with ALB
Monitoring	Manual health checks	CloudWatch + X-Ray

9.4 What Transfers Directly

The following components are **infrastructure-agnostic** and transfer to Bedrock without modification:

- **GGSr algorithm:** Weight matrix, hop-decay scoring, query classification—pure application logic
- **Ingestion pipeline:** Seven Python/JS scripts that parse code and create relationships
- **MCP tool surface:** 43 tools with their parameter schemas and response formats
- **SDD Framework:** Session tracking, workflow specifications, audit trail
- **Evaluation corpus:** 50-query benchmark for regression testing

9.5 What Bedrock Unlocks

1. **LLM-generated community summaries:** Replace template summaries with rich, contextual descriptions (addressing the GLOBAL query regression).
2. **Multimodal embeddings:** Ingest architecture diagrams, workflow flowcharts, and system documentation alongside code.
3. **Multi-user scaling:** ALB + ECS enables concurrent access for the full Global Workflow development team.
4. **Cross-repository knowledge:** Extend the graph beyond the 16 current submodules to the broader UFS ecosystem.
5. **Compliance automation:** FedRAMP-authorized AI for automated EE2 compliance checking in CI/CD pipelines.

9.6 Federal Compliance

The migration to Bedrock satisfies federal requirements:

- **FedRAMP [8]:** AWS GovCloud is FedRAMP High authorized
- **NIST AI RMF [12]:** Session-tracked development provides the audit trails required by the AI Risk Management Framework

- **Vendor independence:** The GGSR algorithm and MCP tools are not AWS-specific; Neptune can be replaced with any Gremlin/openCypher-compatible graph database

10 Discussion

10.1 Why Deterministic Graphs Matter

The fundamental insight of this work is that **code graphs should be built from code, not from LLM interpretation of code**. When an LLM extracts entities from a function’s documentation, it may hallucinate a relationship that doesn’t exist in the source, miss an implicit dependency, or misclassify a node type. When a static analyzer parses a Fortran **CALL** statement, there is no ambiguity.

This deterministic foundation means:

1. **Zero hallucinated edges:** Every relationship is syntactically verifiable
2. **Complete coverage:** The parser processes every file, not a sample
3. **Reproducibility:** Re-running ingestion on the same source produces the identical graph
4. **Auditability:** Each edge traces to a specific line in a specific file

10.2 Limitations

10.2.1 Global Query Regression

The full system underperforms baseline on global queries (40% vs. 80%) because community summaries are template-generated rather than LLM-generated. This is the primary motivation for the Bedrock migration, where managed LLM access enables rich summary generation at scale.

10.2.2 Static Analysis Boundaries

Static analysis cannot capture runtime behavior: dynamic dispatch, configuration-dependent code paths, or data-dependent branching. The graph reflects syntactic structure, not runtime semantics. For operational weather code (primarily Fortran with fixed call graphs), this limitation is minor.

10.2.3 Single-Repository Scope

The current graph covers 16 submodules of the Global Workflow. External dependencies (NCEP libraries, third-party tools) are represented as placeholder nodes. Full cross-repository analysis requires ingesting additional source trees.

10.3 Comparison with Industry Approaches

Table 14: Comparison with industry GraphRAG approaches.

Feature	This Work	MS GraphRAG	GitHub Copilot
Graph source	Static analysis	LLM extraction	None (vector only)
Edge correctness	Deterministic	Approximate	N/A
Community detection	Leiden (0.81)	Leiden	None
Cross-language	4 languages	N/A	Limited
MCP tools	43	N/A	Built-in
Domain-specific	Yes (weather)	Generic	Generic

11 Conclusion

We have presented a **domain-specific GraphRAG system** that achieves a 50% relative improvement in retrieval accuracy over vector-only RAG for NOAA’s operational weather forecasting codebase.

The system’s distinguishing characteristic is its **deterministic knowledge graph**—40,422 nodes and 567,665 relationships built entirely from static code analysis, not LLM extraction. This provides ground-truth structural context that no embedding model can replicate: cross-language execution bridges from Shell through Fortran to subroutine call chains, hierarchical community structure via Leiden detection, and weighted relationship scoring that prioritizes the most structurally relevant context.

Three results stand out:

1. **Cross-language queries: 30%→100%.** The EXECUTES bridges between Shell and Fortran transform a query class that was nearly impossible with vector search into one with perfect accuracy.
2. **Trace queries: 10%→60%.** Graph traversal with weighted scoring enables execution path analysis that vector similarity fundamentally cannot provide.
3. **Sub-200ms latency.** The full GGSР pipeline adds approximately 20ms over baseline vector search—a marginal cost for transformative structural context.

This work represents a **technical achievement** for the agency: a production-validated GraphRAG architecture with a clear migration path to AWS Bedrock, where managed graph databases, FedRAMP-authorized LLMs, and multimodal embedding services can scale this capability across NOAA’s software portfolio. The charter we seek is to execute that migration—taking a proven prototype to production infrastructure capable of serving the full Global Workflow development team.

The GGSР algorithm, ingestion pipeline, 43 MCP tools, and evaluation corpus are all infrastructure-agnostic and ready for deployment on managed cloud services. The question is no longer whether GraphRAG works for operational code intelligence. **It does.** The question is how rapidly we can deliver it at scale.

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A GGSR Relationship Weight Matrix (Complete)

Table 15: Complete GGSR weight matrix (23 relationship types).

Relationship	Weight	Relationship	Weight
CALLS	1.00	EXPORTS	0.60
EXECUTES	1.00	DOC_REFERENCES	0.60
SOURCES	0.95	DOC_DESCRIBES	0.55
INVOKES	0.90	HAS_METHOD	0.50
CALLED_BY	0.90	CONTAINS	0.50
DEPENDS_ON	0.80	SETS	0.50
DEPENDS_ON_ENV	0.80	SAME_DIRECTORY	0.40
IMPORTS	0.70	BUILT_BY	0.35
USES	0.70	BUILD_ORCH.	0.35
INHERITS	0.70	AUTHORED	0.30
DEFINES	0.65	AUTHORED_BY	0.30
		CONTRIBUTED_TO	0.30

Default weight for unknown relationship types: 0.3.

Hop decay factor: $\delta = 0.5$ per hop.

B Evaluation Corpus Categories

Table 16: Sample queries from the 50-query evaluation corpus.

Category	Sample Queries
LOCAL	“What does setuprad call?” “What functions are in module_radiance.f90?”
GLOBAL	“What is the error handling strategy in global-workflow?” “How is observation processing organized?”
TRACE	“What calls exgfs_atmos_post?” “Trace the atms_spatial_average execution path”
CROSS-LANG	“What Fortran does the forecast job execute?” “What programs does enkf_chgres_recenter depend on?”
COMPARATIVE	“How does HERA configuration differ from WCOSS2?” “Compare atmospheric vs. ocean analysis workflows”

C Glossary

Term	Meaning
EE2	EMC Environment 2.0 (NCO production coding standards)
GDS	Graph Data Science (Neo4j library)
GEFS	Global Ensemble Forecast System
GFS	Global Forecast System
GGSR	Graph-Guided Semantic Retrieval
GSI	Gridpoint Statistical Interpolation
HPC	High-Performance Computing
MCP	Model Context Protocol
MPNet	Masked and Permuted Network (embedding model)
NCO	NCEP Central Operations
RAG	Retrieval-Augmented Generation
SDD	Spec-Driven Development
UFS	Unified Forecast System
WCSS2	Weather and Climate Operational Supercomputer 2